PROJECT REPORT

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COURSE: DIGITAL LITERACY

Digital Literacy Ambassador Project Report

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Introduction to Digital Literacy

Digital literacy refers to the ability to use digital technologies such as computers, smartphones, the internet, and online platforms effectively, safely, and responsibly. In today's modern academic environment, digital literacy is not only limited to operating devices but also includes evaluating online information, communicating professionally, protecting personal data, and using digital tools for collaboration and learning.

For college students, digital literacy plays a very important role in improving academic performance, building professional identity, and preparing for future careers. Students regularly use digital platforms for attending lectures, submitting assignments, participating in discussions, and exploring internship opportunities. Therefore, developing strong digital literacy skills helps students become confident, responsible, and productive users of technology.

Digital literacy provides several advantages for students. It improves access to educational resources such as online lectures, e-books, research journals, and learning platforms. It also helps students communicate effectively through email, video conferencing tools, and collaboration platforms like Google Workspace. Another important benefit is that it supports career development by enabling students to build professional profiles on platforms like GitHub and LinkedIn. Additionally, digital literacy encourages creativity, critical thinking, and independent learning through exposure to diverse online content and tools.

Demerits of Digital Literacy

Despite its many advantages, digital literacy also has some limitations if not used responsibly. Excessive dependence on digital devices may lead to distraction and reduced productivity. Students may also face risks such as cybercrime, phishing attacks, identity theft, and misuse of personal information. Another challenge is the spread of misinformation on social media platforms, which can affect decision-making if information is not verified carefully. Therefore, responsible and balanced use of digital technology is essential.

Importance of Digital Literacy for Students

Digital literacy is essential for academic success and professional growth in the modern world. It helps students complete assignments efficiently, collaborate with peers, participate in online learning environments, and stay updated with technological advancements. It also prepares students for workplace expectations, where digital communication, data handling, and online collaboration are necessary skills. Developing digital literacy at an early stage ensures that students become confident digital citizens who can use technology safely and effectively.

Task 1 – Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For this task, I created a one-page Digital Literacy Awareness infographic using **Canva**, which is a widely used online design platform that allows users to create posters, presentations, and visual learning materials easily. The purpose of the infographic was to help my batchmates understand what digital literacy means and why it is essential for students in today's academic and professional environment.

In the infographic, I covered three major components of digital literacy. First, I explained **what digital literacy is**, describing it as the ability to use digital devices, online platforms, and internet resources safely, responsibly, and effectively for learning, communication, and collaboration. Second, I highlighted **useful digital tools for students**, such as Google Drive for storing academic material, GitHub for managing coding projects and collaboration, and LinkedIn for building a professional online presence. Third, I included **safe internet practices**, such as using strong passwords, avoiding suspicious links, protecting personal data, and enabling two-factor authentication.

While designing the infographic, I learned how important visual communication is in presenting information clearly and attractively. The most interesting part of the task was selecting icons, colours, and layouts that made the content easy to understand at a glance. One challenge I faced was arranging multiple ideas in a limited space while keeping the design neat and readable.

Task 2 – Student Digital Portfolio

In this task, I created and updated my profiles on three important professional platforms: **GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle**. These platforms help students develop a strong digital presence and showcase their academic progress, technical skills, and learning interests.

On GitHub, I created a profile README that includes my name, academic details, and learning goals. GitHub is especially useful for storing programming assignments, sharing projects, and demonstrating coding progress to recruiters and collaborators. Maintaining an active GitHub profile over time helps build a strong technical portfolio.

On LinkedIn, I updated my Education section with details about my degree at VIT Bhopal University and my expected graduation timeline. LinkedIn is an important professional networking platform that allows students to connect with seniors, faculty members, and industry professionals. It also helps students stay informed about internship opportunities and career trends.

On Kaggle, I created a beginner-level profile to start exploring datasets and data science learning resources. Kaggle is useful for practising data analysis, participating in competitions, and improving problem-solving skills using real-world data.

Over the next four years, I plan to upload academic and personal projects on GitHub regularly, build professional connections through LinkedIn, and gradually explore data science tools and datasets on Kaggle to strengthen my analytical skills.

Task 3 – Coding & Collaboration Platforms

As part of this task, I explored both a coding practice platform and a cloud collaboration tool to improve my technical learning experience.

For coding practice, I created an account on **HackerRank** and completed a beginner-level programming challenge. This helped me understand how coding platforms provide structured problem-solving exercises that improve logical thinking, programming accuracy, and confidence. Regular practice on such platforms prepares students for technical interviews and strengthens their understanding of programming concepts.

For collaboration, I created a **Google Form** titled "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" containing five questions related to safe internet usage, digital tools, and responsible online behaviour. The form included both multiple-choice and short-answer questions to ensure different types of responses could be collected. I also connected the form responses to a Google Sheet, which allows automatic storage and easy analysis of student responses.

These tools are highly useful for academic purposes. Coding platforms help improve programming skills through practice, while Google Forms supports surveys, quizzes, and feedback collection for classroom activities and group projects. Learning to use these tools effectively will support my academic development and teamwork skills.

Task 4 – Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

Digital communication plays an important role in academic and professional environments. During this task, I learned how improper email communication can create confusion, delays, or even missed opportunities. For example, if a student sends an email to a professor requesting an assignment extension without a subject line, greeting, or proper explanation, the professor may not clearly understand the request or may ignore the message entirely. Similarly, sending informal or incomplete emails to internship coordinators can create a negative impression and reduce the chances of receiving a response.

Such situations can be avoided by following proper email etiquette. A professional email should include a clear subject line that reflects the purpose of the message, a respectful greeting such as "Respected Sir/Madam" or "Dear Professor," a well-structured body explaining the request briefly and clearly, and a proper sign-off including the student’s name and academic details. Using polite language and maintaining clarity improves communication effectiveness and reflects professionalism.

Learning these practices will help me communicate more confidently with faculty members, internship coordinators, and future employers.

Task 5 – Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

While researching cybercrime awareness, I studied common digital fraud methods affecting college students, especially **UPI payment fraud and phishing attacks**. These scams usually involve attackers pretending to be bank officials, customer support representatives, or online sellers who trick users into sharing OTPs or approving fraudulent payment requests. In many cases, victims lose money within seconds after approving a fake collect request.

One thing that surprised me the most during this research was how simple social engineering techniques can be used to manipulate users into trusting fake messages or calls. Many students are unaware that even a small mistake, such as clicking an unknown link or sharing an OTP, can result in financial loss or identity misuse.

As a result of this task, one important habit I will personally change is verifying every payment request carefully before approving it and avoiding interaction with unknown links or suspicious messages. I will also make sure to report any cyber fraud immediately through the National Cyber Crime Portal or helpline 1930 if such situations occur in the future.

This task increased my awareness about online threats and helped me understand the importance of practising safe digital behaviour in everyday life.

Conclusion

This design handed a comprehensive understanding of digital knowledge and its significance in everyday life. It helped me develop practical chops similar as creating digital content, maintaining an online presence, using collaboration tools, and communicating professionally. I also gained mindfulness about cyber pitfalls and how to stay safe online. These literacy will be largely salutary in my academic trip and future career. Overall, this design enhanced my confidence in using digital platforms effectively and responsibly.---

References

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Project Overview

This project demonstrates digital literacy skills including infographic creation, digital portfolio setup, platform exploration, email etiquette, and cybercrime awareness.

Tasks Summary

-Task 1: Created infographic on digital literacy

-Task 2: Built digital profiles (GitHub, LinkedIn, Kaggle)

-Task 3: Completed coding challenge & Google Form quiz

-Task 4: Wrote professional emails & checklist

-Task 5: Created cybercrime case study & prevention tips

FOLDER CHECKLIST

✓ task-1-presentation → Presentation image ✓ task-2-portfolio → profile screenshots ✓ task-3-platforms → coding + form screenshots ✓ task-4-email-etiquette → emails + checklist ✓ task-5-cybercrime → case study + checklist ✓report → Project_Report.pdf

As a result of this research, one habit I will personally change is carefully verifying all payment requests before approving them and never sharing OTPs with anyone. I will also make sure to report suspicious activity immediately through official cybercrime reporting channels if needed.

Understanding these risks has made me more aware of the importance of safe online behaviour and responsible use of digital financial platforms.